

Final Presentation — Speaker Notes

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Structure: 26 main slides + 4 backup. Framing throughout is paper vs our implementation. No internal-iteration history in what the audience hears.

Slide 1. Title

- Final presentation of our paper reproduction project — Shi, Lee, Yang (IEEE CASE 2024).
- Presentation structure: recap, reproduction scope, implementation requirements, reproduction results, extensions, and summary.

Slide 2. Recap: Simulating Emergency Evacuation

- Brief recap from our 1st presentation. The paper studies how thousands of pedestrians evacuate when a hazard affects a community.
- The slide only lists the three main reasons this is hard: independent decisions, local information, and emergent panic/congestion. Say the fuller version verbally: each person chooses a destination and route, those choices depend on nearby roads and hazard exposure, and congestion is not imposed globally but emerges from many individual movements.
- Therefore a traditional process-flow model is too aggregated. The paper uses agent-based simulation so each pedestrian has its own state, position, speed, destination, and decision logic.

Slide 3. Recap: Three-Component Model

- Three coupled components from the paper: community network, human agents, hazard agents.
- Two algorithms tie them together — Algorithm 1 (human-network) and Algorithm 2 (human-hazard). Both run every step.

Slide 4. Recap: Agent States & Algorithms 1–2

- Six states per human, with Algorithm 2 handling hazard exposure and Algorithm 1 handling routing. The slide is intentionally compressed; give the operational details verbally.
- Algorithm 2 runs every step: if an agent is inside a hazard for the first time, it becomes impacted and reroutes to a shelter; then casualty risk and panic are checked. Casualty probability is higher near the hazard center.
- Algorithm 1 also runs every step: agents on edges check congestion and may queue; agents at nodes reroute, continue toward a destination, or choose a random route if panic has taken over.

- Two points worth emphasizing: once impacted, destination flips to the nearest shelter; panic is irreversible.
- We take both algorithms directly from the paper — no changes to the decision logic.

Slide 5. Reproduction and extension scope

- Three reproduction targets from the paper: Phase 1 (five community networks), Phase 2a (RI vs $P_{\max} \times H_{\max}$), Phase 2b ($RS/RC/RL$ vs panic).
- If needed, expand the abbreviations verbally: RI is impacted rate, RS is survival rate, RC is casualty rate, and RL is leftover rate, meaning agents still stuck in hazard at the end.
- Three extensions beyond the paper’s range: wider $P_{\max}$, wider $H_{\max}$, finer panic grid.
- The notation box at top defines every symbol used later.

Slide 6. Implementation specifications and reproducibility gaps

- The paper specifies the implementation environment, hardware, and measured runtime, but it does not fully specify the computational implementation. Algorithms 1 and 2 define decision logic, not the path-computation mechanism.
- The main unspecified details are shortest-path implementation, per-step versus cached path policy, parallel execution, RNG design, and reproducibility seeding. These choices materially affect whether a multi-seed reproduction is feasible.
- Key takeaway: at the paper’s 2.5 h/run baseline, our 390-run core grid would require about 41 days of sequential compute. The optimized pipeline completes that grid in 3.4 hours, making the subsequent reproduction and extension analyses practical.

Slide 7. Computational bottleneck: repeated path computation

- Algorithm 1 path recomputation dominates runtime: 2,000 agents across 121 steps is roughly 242K shortest-path queries per run.
- Optimization: many agents share destinations, so instead of asking the graph for a new path for every agent, we group by destination, build one predecessor tree for each destination, and reconstruct each agent’s path from that tree.
- The lower summary box reports the measured runtime change: the routing subsystem drops from 165.9 seconds to about 20.0 seconds including tree construction, and the full run drops from 168 seconds to 22.5 seconds.

Slide 8. Experimental design for scalable reproduction

- Three implementation decisions support scalable reproduction: recompute paths every step, execute the grid with 8 workers, and vary agent seeds while keeping the hazard seed fixed.
- These are implementation choices, not new behavioral rules. They preserve the original model logic while making multi-seed reproduction possible.

Slide 9. Experimental scale enabled by the implementation

- The optimized implementation supports four analysis components: 10 seeds per configuration, a 390-run core grid, a 510-run Pmax sweep, and three visual comparison animations.
- The gray caption reports the measured speedup: 7.5x single-process and about 60x with 8 workers.

Slide 10. Baseline PSU-UP simulation on the reproduced network

- Animation on the paper’s baseline ($P_{\max} = 2,000$, $H_{\max} = 5$, panic 10%).
- In the animation, hazards appear, impacted agents reroute to shelters, some become casualties, and the remaining agents arrive. Final RI is about 36%, matching the Phase 2a chart on slide 13.

Slide 11. Phase 1: Network validation

- Building counts match the paper’s Table V within 0–2% across all five communities.
- Edge counts: PSU-UP, UVA-C, VT-B line up. RA-PA and KOP-PA are anomalous — paper’s E/N ratios of 6.5–6.8 are unreproducible with any OSMnx configuration we tried. Treated as a paper data anomaly; details in backup slide 29.

Slide 12. Phase 1: PSU-UP figures

- Top: Fig. 3 reproduction — the PSU-UP walk network, with 969 building nodes and the supplemented shelter set fixed before later experiments.
- Bottom: Fig. 4 reproduction — pedestrian flow snapshots at five times during a hazard scenario. The key visual check is that impacted agents appear after hazards emerge, then most agents move into survival or arrival states by the end.

Slide 13. Phase 2a: RI vs $P_{\max} \times H_{\max}$

- Fig. 5 reproduction. Our qualitative trend matches: RI increases with $H_{\max}$ and is nearly independent of $P_{\max}$ in the paper range.
- Critical confirmation: RI is independent of $P_{\max}$ from 2K to 8K (delta under 0.2%p). This is the paper’s core finding, and we reproduced it.
- Quantitative match is partial, not exact: mean absolute error is about 5 percentage points and the largest gap is about 9 percentage points.

Slide 14. Phase 2b: $RS/RC/RL$ vs panic

- Fig. 6 reproduction using the paper’s five panic points. All three directions match: higher panic lowers survival and raises casualty and leftover.
- Quantitative levels are only partially matched. The largest visible gap is high-panic casualty: our implementation levels off near 6%, while the paper reaches about 13%.
- Therefore the academically precise interpretation is qualitative reproduction with remaining model gaps, rather than exact numerical reproduction.

Slide 15. Calibration choices and remaining gaps

- The slide is intentionally simpler than the notes: the three main unpublished inputs are shelter locations, casualty formula, and hazard seed. We calibrated each once, then held it fixed for the rest of the deck.
- Shelter locations matter most for survival. The table shows why we use about 600 shelters: it gives 64.3% survival at panic = 90%, closest to the paper’s 64.6%.
- The remaining gaps should be stated explicitly: RI is a little high overall, and high-panic casualty remains low because our casualty formula is conservative relative to the paper’s implied behavior.

Slide 16. Extension study design beyond the paper range

- The optimized pipeline supports three controlled extensions beyond the paper range.
- The paper tested $P_{\max}$ up to 8K, $H_{\max}$ up to 15, and panic at five points. We extend each axis in the next three slides.

Slide 17. Extension 1: $P_{\max}$ threshold

- Extended $P_{\max}$ from 2K to 97K across three $H_{\max}$ levels.
- Independence holds up to 20K, and a measurable deviation appears at 50K by +8.5%p.
- Mechanism hypothesis: at 50K, building-to-network connectors and nearby walk edges become bottlenecks, so more agents queue outdoors and remain exposed longer.

Slide 18. Extension 2: $H_{\max}$ saturation

- Extended $H_{\max}$ from 5 to 30 at paper-baseline $P_{\max}$.
- RI approaches an empirical plateau near 86% by $H_{\max} = 30$.
- Interpretation: under this hazard-generation process, the remaining 14% appears to be low-exposure or peripheral origins, not a universal ceiling.

Slide 19. Extension 3: Finer panic grid

- 9 panic points vs the paper’s 5.
- Curves are smooth and monotonic at 10% resolution; no abrupt transition is visible in this calibrated scenario.
- Model implication: marginal panic reduction has the largest effect at low baseline panic.

Slide 20. Visual comparison 1: $P_{\max}$ 2K vs 50K

- Same hazard scenario, different $P_{\max}$. Emphasize outdoor queuing in the high- $P_{\max}$ panel.

Slide 21. Visual comparison 2: panic 10% vs 90%

- Same hazard, different panic rate. High-panic agents select random routes more often instead of moving directly toward shelters.

Slide 22. Visual comparison 3: $H_{\max}$ 5 vs 30

- Hazard counts differ by design — say this explicitly. Left has 5 hazards, right has 30.
- The right panel shows substantially broader hazard coverage, so agents are exposed repeatedly.

Slide 23. Summary

- Summary structure is now three columns: reproduction, engineering, and extensions.
- The conclusion: the paper’s qualitative behavior is reproduced, and the scalable pipeline enables controlled follow-up experiments without changing the behavioral state logic.
- The three-number dashboard keeps only communities, total simulation runs, and overall speedup.

Slide 24. Scope and limitations

- Analysis scope: faithful paper reproduction, an implementation improvement, and three controlled extensions.
- Out-of-scope extensions: agent-model changes, casualty-formula rewrite, and multi-community extension of Phase 2. These remain future-work directions because they change the model layer rather than only the experimental design.

Slide 25. Team contributions

- This slide satisfies the project guide requirement to delineate each member’s contribution in the report.
- Keep the delivery brief: individual technical roles first, then shared work across environment setup, debugging, result checking, presentation preparation, README writing, final code review, and final report approval.

Slide 26. References & acknowledgements

- Acknowledge the primary paper, the 2021 companion paper we used to disambiguate preprocessing, OSMnx, and SciPy.
- Code and data on GitHub. Thank the audience; invite questions.

Slide 27. Backup: Future work

- If asked about future work: the paper’s own suggestions — response agents, social-force, MDP panic model — plus our own observation that a panic-dependent casualty formula could close the RC ceiling gap.

Slide 28. Backup: $P_{\max}$ threshold generalization

- If asked whether the high- $P_{\max}$ threshold is specific to PSU-UP: multi-community $P_{\max}$ data is in this table. Pattern is consistent across communities with different building counts.

Slide 29. Backup: Edge count anomaly

- If asked about the RA-PA and KOP-PA mismatch: this backup has the diagnostic table. Paper reports E/N of 6.5–6.8, which is implausibly high for pedestrian walk networks and unreproducible with any standard OSMnx configuration.

Slide 30. Backup: Static snapshots

- If the venue's PDF viewer does not play the embedded animations: these still frames are the fallback.